

Northlight Robotics GmbH — Annual Report 2025 (Extract)

Management Summary

Fiscal year 2025 marked Northlight Robotics' transition from pilot-stage startup to profitable scale-up. Revenue grew 50% year-on-year to EUR 2.1 million, driven primarily by recurring inspection contracts with North Sea port operators. The company remained profitable for the second consecutive year and reinvested 30% of net profit into research and development of the ScanGuard autonomous docking platform.

Key Performance Indicators

- Revenue: EUR 2,100,000 (+50% vs 2024)
- Inspection runs completed: 4,120 across 12 EU ports
- Defect detection precision: 94% on validated ground-truth datasets
- Mean inspection cost per crane: EUR 1,150 (vs EUR 4,000 manual baseline)
- Reportable safety incidents: 0

Research and Development

R&D; expenditure totalled EUR 540,000 (26% of revenue). Highlights include the marine-rated self-docking drone nest (IP67), on-board defect classification in under 900 ms on embedded hardware, and a predictive-maintenance API integrated with two commercial port asset-management systems. The core platform is at TRL 7; the ScanGuard autonomy stack is targeted at TRL 8 by end of 2027 pending multi-climate validation.

Outlook and Funding Requirements

To reach commercial scale, Northlight requires EUR 1.8-2.5 million in non-dilutive funding over 36 months for multi-port validation, CE conformity, and manufacturing readiness. The company is preparing applications under EU Horizon Europe programme instruments and seeks one academic partner in computer vision and one port authority pilot site.